Practical 3: Filter RetailPulse Sales by Region and Date

Related topic: Focus Reports Using Filters

Objective

Apply a simple filter and an advanced detail filter to scope a report to a single region and reporting period, then generalize it with a prompt.

Materials required

IBM Cognos Analytics access, the grouped RetailPulse list report from Practical 2.

Step-by-step procedure

1. Open the RetailPulse list report built in Practical 2.
2. Open the **Filters** pane (Filter icon) and add a simple filter: **Region = "North"**.
3. Add an advanced detail filter (**Filters > Add > Advanced**, Detail filter, *Before aggregation*) with the expression: `[Sales Date] between 2026-10-01 and 2026-12-31` (the current quarter start and end dates).
4. Combine both conditions with **AND** (set the connector between the two filters to AND in the Filters pane / Advanced expression).
5. **Run** the report and confirm the row count drops to match the filtered scope (e.g. 32 rows → 8 rows).
6. Select the Region filter, change **Prompt: Ask every time** (i.e. convert to a prompted filter), so other managers can reuse it. Re-run and choose "South" to test.

Combined filter expression

```
[Region] = 'North' AND [Sales Date] BETWEEN 2026-10-01 AND 2026-12-31
```

Prompted version (Region): `[Region] = ?Region? AND [Sales Date] BETWEEN 2026-10-01 AND 2026-12-31`

Expected output (illustrative, Q4-to-date figures)

RetailPulse – Sales by Region and Store Filter: Region = North, Oct–Dec 2026

Region	Store Name	Product Category	Quantity	Sales Amount
North	Chicago Loop	Electronics	29	$17,500
North	Chicago Loop	Apparel	41	$3,333
North	Chicago Loop	Home & Garden	21	$3,033
North	Chicago Loop	Grocery	110	$2,750
North	Minneapolis Mall	Electronics	23	$14,000
North	Minneapolis Mall	Apparel	37	$3,033
North	Minneapolis Mall	Home & Garden	20	$2,800
North	Minneapolis Mall	Grocery	91	$2,291

Mock-up: only North rows for the current quarter remain (8 rows vs 32 unfiltered). Re-running the prompted version with 'South' returns Atlanta Peachtree and Miami Beach rows instead.

Expected outcome
Only rows satisfying both conditions remain; the row count is visibly smaller than the unfiltered report; the prompted version returns a different region's data when re-run with a new value.